

Mary's Fast Computer Skills

Mary is working on a computer project in class. She wants to work fast without using her mouse all the time. First, Mary presses **CTRL+A** to **select all** the text in her window at once. Then, she presses **CTRL+C** to **copy** the text. This puts the words onto her computer clipboard without deleting the original words. Next, Mary moves her typing cursor to a new page and presses **CTRL+V** to **paste** the words. She does not need to retype anything!

Mary sees a sentence in the wrong place. She selects the sentence and presses **CTRL+X** to **cut (remove)** it from that spot. She moves her cursor down and pastes it where it belongs. Suddenly, Mary makes a mistake and deletes her work! She does not panic. She presses **CTRL+Z** to **undo** her mistake, and her work comes back instantly. If she wants to bring back what she just undid, she presses **CTRL+Y** to **redo** the action.

Mary has many apps open. She holds **ALT** and presses **TAB (ALT+TAB)** to **switch between open windows** very fast. When she finishes using an app, she presses **ALT+F4** to **close the open program**. She is careful with ALT+F4 because unsaved work can be lost! Finally, Mary presses **CTRL+S** every few minutes to **save her progress** to the drive. Saving keeps her work safe if the computer turns off.

Understanding File Paths (File Addresses)

Mary saved her homework screenshot to this exact file address:

"E:\QA\Pictures\Screenshots\Screenshot1.png"

1. Drive Letter (E:\): The storage drive (like a USB flash drive or hard drive).
2. Folders (QA \ Pictures \ Screenshots): Folders inside other folders (the folder path).
3. File Name (Screenshot1): The name Mary gave to her picture.
4. File Extension (.png): The file type (shows that it is an image/picture file).

Quick Glossary: Shortcuts & Definitions

Shortcut / Word	What it does (Action)	Why it is useful (Benefit)
CTRL + C	Copy text or files to clipboard.	Duplicates items without deleting the original text.
CTRL + V	Paste clipboard items.	Puts copied text onto the page fast without retyping.
CTRL + Z	Undo the last action.	Fixes mistakes and brings back deleted work.
CTRL + Y	Redo the undone action.	Brings back changes you just undid.
CTRL + X	Cut (remove) text or files.	Removes an item and lets you move it to a new spot.
CTRL + A	Select All items on screen.	Highlights everything in one click to copy, move, or delete.
CTRL + S	Save work to the drive.	Keeps your file safe so you don't lose work if computer turns off.
ALT + TAB	Switch between open windows.	Lets you jump between open apps fast without a mouse.
ALT + F4	Close the open program.	Closes an app window quickly (be careful with unsaved work!).
File Path	Full address of a file.	Tells the computer where a file is: Drive (E:\), Folders, Name, Type (.png).

 **Quick Tip:** Remember the difference between Copy (CTRL+C keeps the original) and Cut (CTRL+X removes the original)!